

TidyTuesday Week 30

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Saturday 25th July, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the weekly ritual where a computer flings two unrelated economic time series into a blender and I pretend to be surprised by what comes out. This week's contestants included Federal Reserve Treasury holdings, a discontinued Southern services price index, some population data from Nuckolls County, Nebraska (population: fewer than you'd hope), and a price index for congenital anomaly medical expenditures. Truly the crossover episodes nobody asked for. Let me pour one out for our dignity before we begin.

Monday kicked off with the Fed's medium-maturity Treasury holdings versus a CPI series so discontinued it retired back in 2017. The raw regression came out swaggering with an R-squared of 0.77, as if it had discovered something. Then we detrended it, the R-squared slumped to 0.37, and the coefficient literally flipped sign from positive to negative. Nothing says "we were just watching two things drift upward together" quite like a relationship that can't even decide which direction it points once you take away its little time crutch. Classic trend mirage. Dunk registered. Tuesday, however, actually behaved: nonfinancial noncorporate business quasi-corporation withdrawals versus current-cost depreciation of nonresidential structures held onto an R-squared of 0.87 even after detrending, and the coefficient barely budged from 0.42 to 0.40. That's the rare, annoying case where the relationship survives the trend-stripping, probably because both are just proxies for "big dollar amounts sloshing around the business economy." I'm reluctantly impressed, which is a feeling I try to avoid on this project.

Wednesday gave us Nuckolls County's dwindling population predicting a congenital anomaly price index, and the raw fit was a dramatic 0.88 — a coefficient of negative 75, meaning as Nebraskans leave, medical prices climb, which is exactly the kind of ludicrous causal story I'm legally required to tell you is nonsense. Detrended, it slumped to 0.36 but technically stayed "significant," so it's a mirage wearing a slightly convincing hat. Thursday was refreshingly humble: net unilateral transfers versus bank failure transactions produced a raw R-squared of 0.005, which is the statistical equivalent of a shrug, though the detrended version squeaked out a p-value just under 0.05, a "significance" so thin you could read a newspaper through it. And Friday closed strong with government investment in intellectual property versus manufacturing compensation costs — 0.96 raw, 0.84 detrended, coefficient holding steady. Another one that stubbornly refuses to be dismissed.

As always, the mandatory reminder: these are randomly paired series with zero causal intent and no rigorous statistical claim whatsoever. When a relationship "holds up" here, it means the two things happened to wiggle together, not that one causes the other, and not that you should

build a portfolio, a policy, or a personality around it. Spurious correlation is the house special here, served daily. This week just happened to plate a couple of dishes that looked suspiciously edible. Don't eat them anyway. See you next week for more distinguished nonsense.

2 Date: 2026-07-21

Series ID: TREAS1T5

This series is titled Assets: Securities Held Outright: U.S. Treasury Securities: Maturing in over 1 Year to 5 Years: Wednesday Level and has a frequency of Weekly, As of Wednesday. The units are Millions of U.S. Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2002-12-18 and the observation end date is 2026-07-15. The popularity of this series is 21.

Series ID: CUURD300SAS

This series is titled Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers: Services in South - Size Class D (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index 1982-1984=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1977-12-01 and the observation end date is 2017-12-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CUURD300SAS	R-squared:	0.774			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.765			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	82.38			
Date:	Tue, 21 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	3.15e-09			
Time:	13:11:10	Log-Likelihood:	-104.86			
No. Observations:	26	AIC:	213.7			
Df Residuals:	24	BIC:	216.2			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	214.5017	4.768	44.985	0.000	204.660	224.343
value_fred_TREAS1T5	6.405e-05	7.06e-06	9.076	0.000	4.95e-05	7.86e-05
Omnibus:	1.003	Durbin-Watson:	0.294			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.606	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.795			
Skew:	-0.004	Prob(JB):	0.672			
Kurtosis:	2.143	Cond. No.	1.16e+06			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

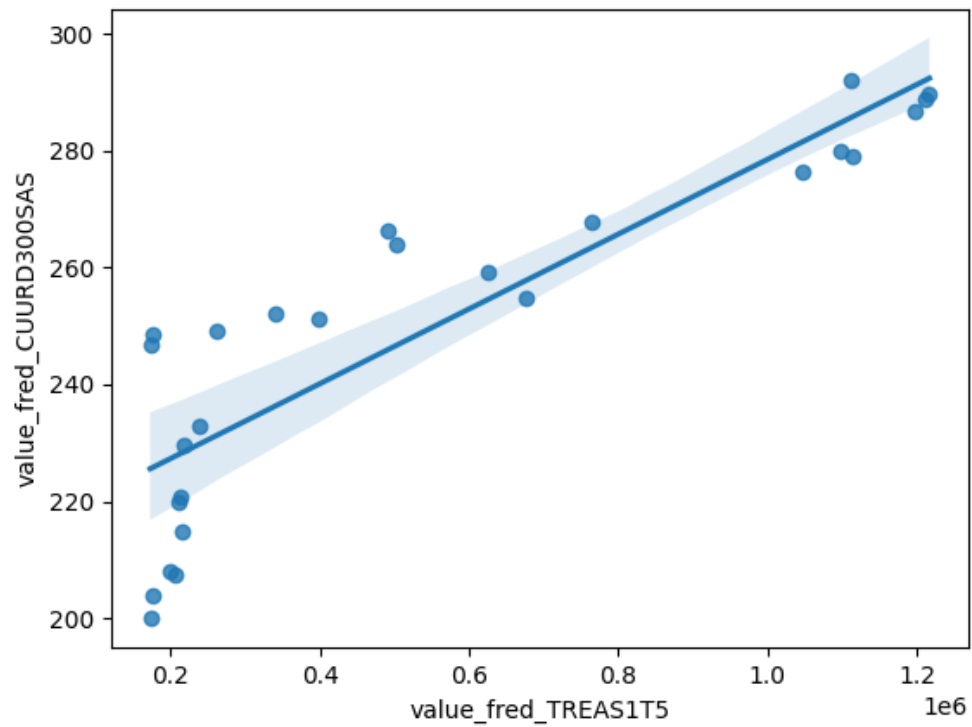


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-07-21

[2] The condition number is large, $1.16e+06$. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CUURD300SAS_detrended	R-squared:	0.365
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.339
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	13.82
Date:	Tue, 21 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.00107
Time:	13:11:11	Log-Likelihood:	-63.094
No. Observations:	26	AIC:	130.2
Df Residuals:	24	BIC:	132.7
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	4.318e-12	0.559	7.72e-12	1.000	-1.154	1.154
value_fred_TREAS1T5_detrended	-1.309e-05	3.52e-06	-3.718	0.001	-2.04e-05	-5.83e-06

Omnibus:	0.194	Durbin-Watson:	1.006
Prob(Omnibus):	0.907	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.403
Skew:	0.028	Prob(JB):	0.818
Kurtosis:	2.393	Cond. No.	1.59e+05

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.59e+05. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

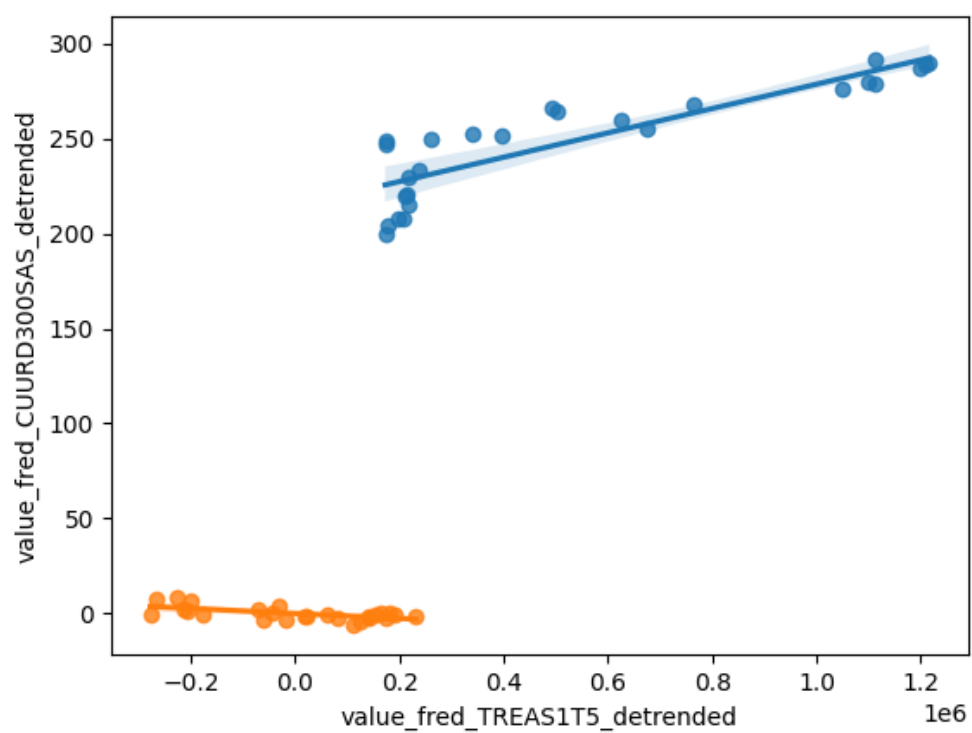


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-07-21

3 Date: 2026-07-22

Series ID: NNBICPA027N

This series is titled Nonfinancial Noncorporate Business; Withdrawals from Income of Quasi-Corporations, Paid, Transactions and has a frequency of Annual, End of Period. The units are Millions of U.S. Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted Annual Rate. The observation start date is 1959-01-01 and the observation end date is 2024-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: M1YTOTL1ST000

This series is titled Current-Cost Depreciation of Private and government fixed assets: Nonresidential: Structures and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1925-01-01 and the observation end date is 2024-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_M1YTOTL1ST000	R-squared:	0.985
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.984
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	4111.
Date:	Wed, 22 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	8.67e-60
Time:	13:16:17	Log-Likelihood:	-777.64
No. Observations:	66	AIC:	1559.
Df Residuals:	64	BIC:	1564.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1720.1069	5808.925	-0.296	0.768	-1.33e+04	9884.554
value_fred_NNBICPA027N	0.4156	0.006	64.115	0.000	0.403	0.429

Omnibus:	7.252	Durbin-Watson:	0.477
Prob(Omnibus):	0.027	Jarque-Bera (JB):	10.958
Skew:	0.289	Prob(JB):	0.00417
Kurtosis:	4.911	Cond. No.	1.31e+06

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

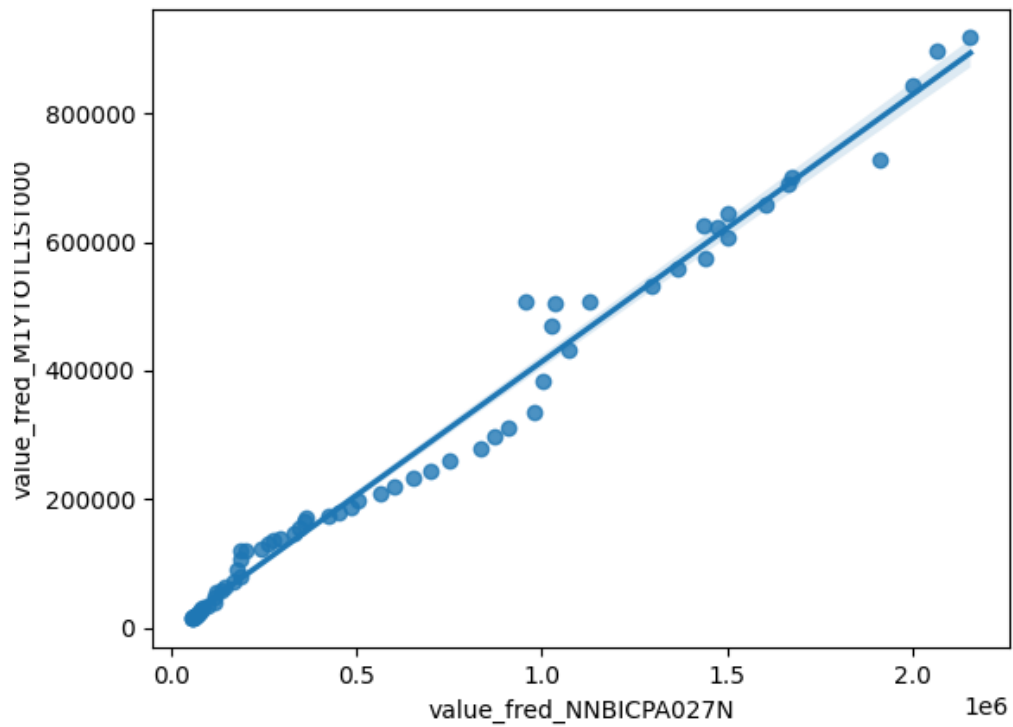


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-07-22

[2] The condition number is large, $1.31e+06$. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_M1YTOTL1ST000_detrended	R-squared:	0.873
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.871
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	439.3
Date:	Wed, 22 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	2.31e-30
Time:	13:16:17	Log-Likelihood:	-777.37
No. Observations:	66	AIC:	1559.
Df Residuals:	64	BIC:	1563.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	2.698e-09	3943.730	6.84e-13	1.000	-7878.507	7878.507
value_fred_NNBICPA027N_detrended	0.4024	0.019	20.960	0.000	0.364	0.441

Omnibus:	5.762	Durbin-Watson:	0.463
Prob(Omnibus):	0.056	Jarque-Bera (JB):	8.362
Skew:	0.128	Prob(JB):	0.0153
Kurtosis:	4.725	Cond. No.	2.05e+05

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.05e+05. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

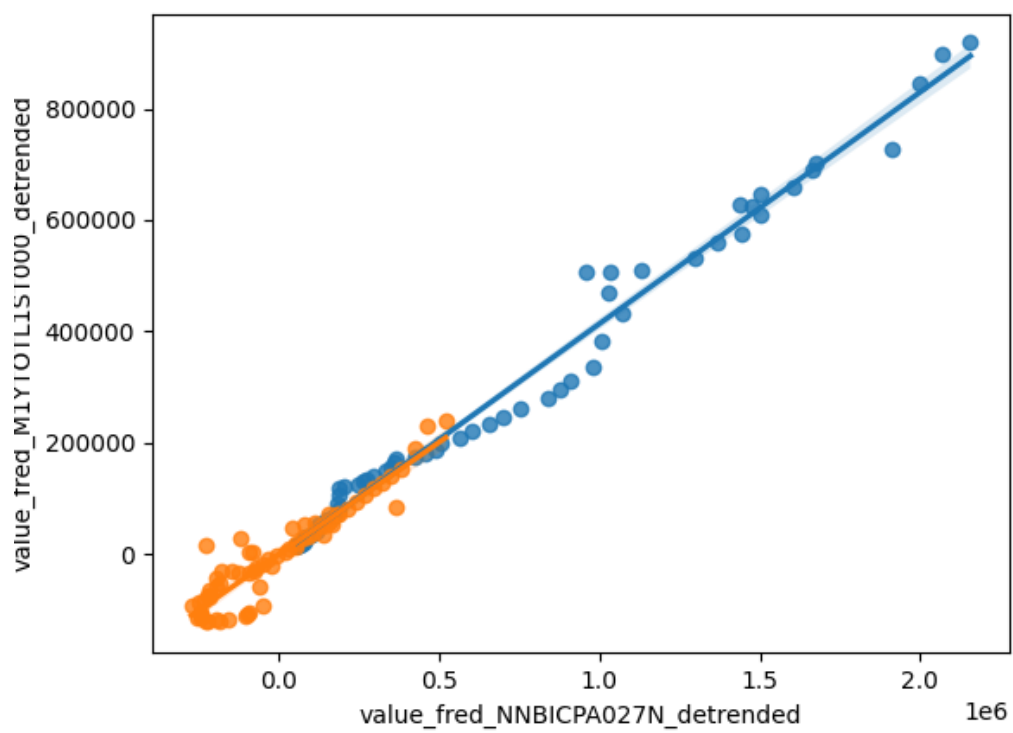


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-07-22

4 Date: 2026-07-23

Series ID: NENUCK9POP

This series is titled Resident Population in Nuckolls County, NE and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Thousands of Persons and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1970-01-01 and the observation end date is 2025-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: COGANOPIBLEND

This series is titled Medical Services Expenditures by Disease: Other: Congenital Anomalies Price Index, Blended Account Basis and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Index 2017=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2000-01-01 and the observation end date is 2021-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_COGANOPIBLEND	R-squared:	0.876			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.870			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	141.6			
Date:	Thu, 23 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	1.58e-10			
Time:	13:20:04	Log-Likelihood:	-75.559			
No. Observations:	22	AIC:	155.1			
Df Residuals:	20	BIC:	157.3			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	422.9442	28.506	14.837	0.000	363.483	482.406
value_fred_NENUCK9POP	-75.7107	6.363	-11.898	0.000	-88.985	-62.437
	Omnibus:	4.239	Durbin-Watson:	1.347		
	Prob(Omnibus):	0.120	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.271		
	Skew:	0.630	Prob(JB):	0.321		
	Kurtosis:	3.944	Cond. No.	79.9		

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

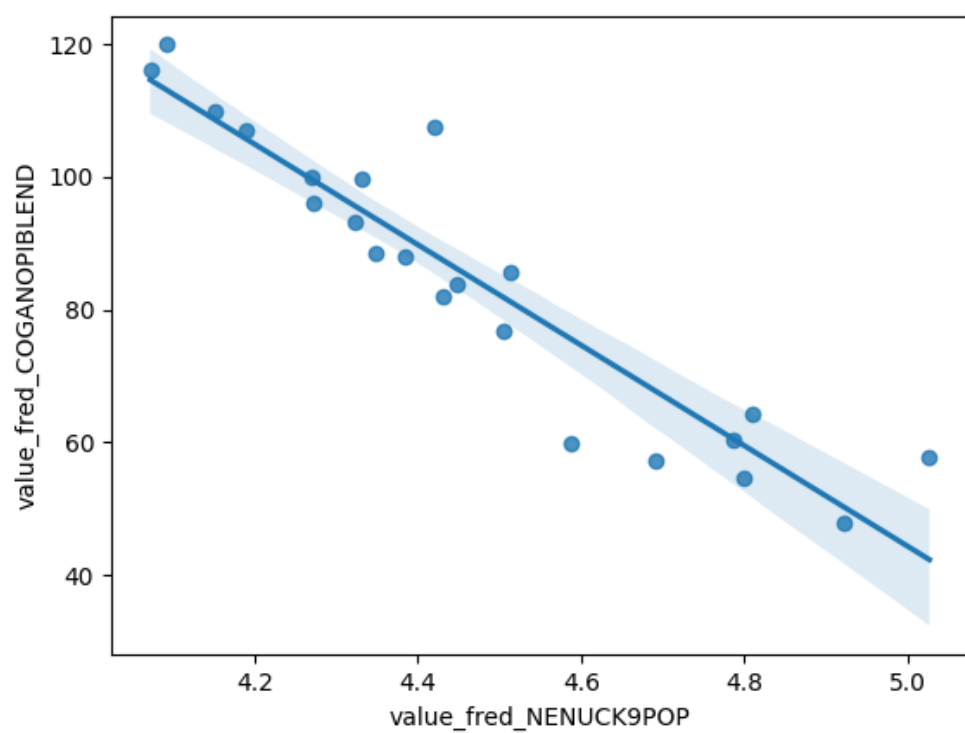


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-07-23

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_COGANOPIBLEND_detrended	R-squared:	0.358
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.326
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	11.17
Date:	Thu, 23 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.00324
Time:	13:20:05	Log-Likelihood:	-75.552
No. Observations:	22	AIC:	155.1
Df Residuals:	20	BIC:	157.3
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	6.695e-12	1.678	3.99e-12	1.000	-3.499	3.499
value_fred_NENUCK9POP_detrended	-78.2472	23.407	-3.343	0.003	-127.074	-29.421

Omnibus:	3.865	Durbin-Watson:	1.355
Prob(Omnibus):	0.145	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.985
Skew:	0.584	Prob(JB):	0.371
Kurtosis:	3.896	Cond. No.	14.0

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

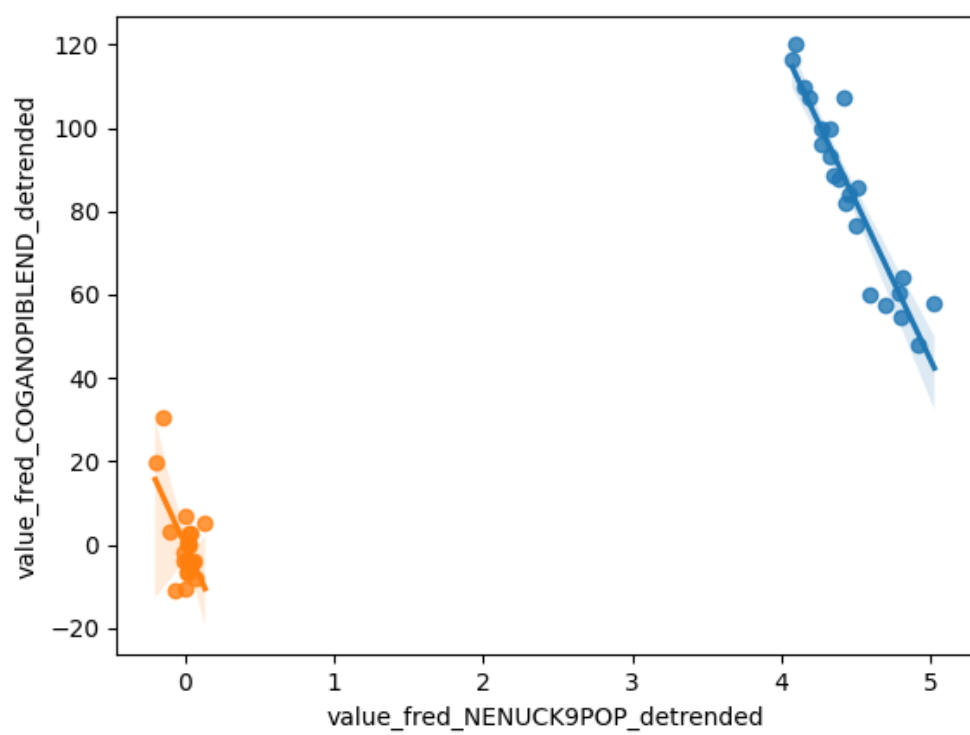


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-07-23

5 Date: 2026-07-24

Series ID: BOPGA

This series is titled Unilateral Transfers, Net (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Billions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1960-01-01 and the observation end date is 2013-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: BKTTPAA641N

This series is titled Failures and Assistance Transactions of all Institutions by Transaction Type (Purchase and Assumption (PA)) for the United States and Other Areas and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Number of Institutions and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1934-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

5.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BKTTPAA641N	R-squared:	0.005
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.014
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.2713
Date:	Fri, 24 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.605
Time:	13:12:01	Log-Likelihood:	-308.19
No. Observations:	54	AIC:	620.4
Df Residuals:	52	BIC:	624.4
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	33.0760	13.835	2.391	0.020	5.313	60.839
value_fred_BOPGA	-0.1284	0.247	-0.521	0.605	-0.623	0.366

Omnibus:	41.852	Durbin-Watson:	0.265
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	110.404
Skew:	2.369	Prob(JB):	1.06e-24
Kurtosis:	8.160	Cond. No.	76.9

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

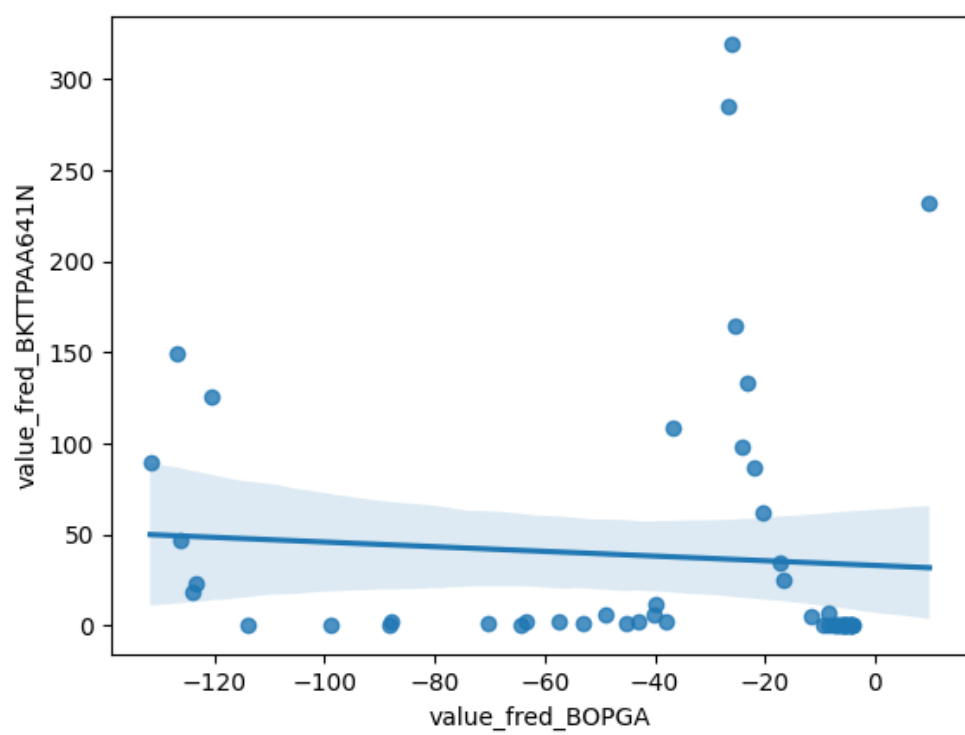


Figure 7: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-07-24

5.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BKTPAA641N_detrended	R-squared:	0.085
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.068
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	4.844
Date:	Fri, 24 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0322
Time:	13:12:01	Log-Likelihood:	-304.45
No. Observations:	54	AIC:	612.9
Df Residuals:	52	BIC:	616.9
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-2.402e-12	9.425	-2.55e-13	1.000	-18.912	18.912
value_fred_BOPGA_detrended	1.0857	0.493	2.201	0.032	0.096	2.076

Omnibus:	31.844	Durbin-Watson:	0.291
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	64.227
Skew:	1.865	Prob(JB):	1.13e-14
Kurtosis:	6.825	Cond. No.	19.1

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

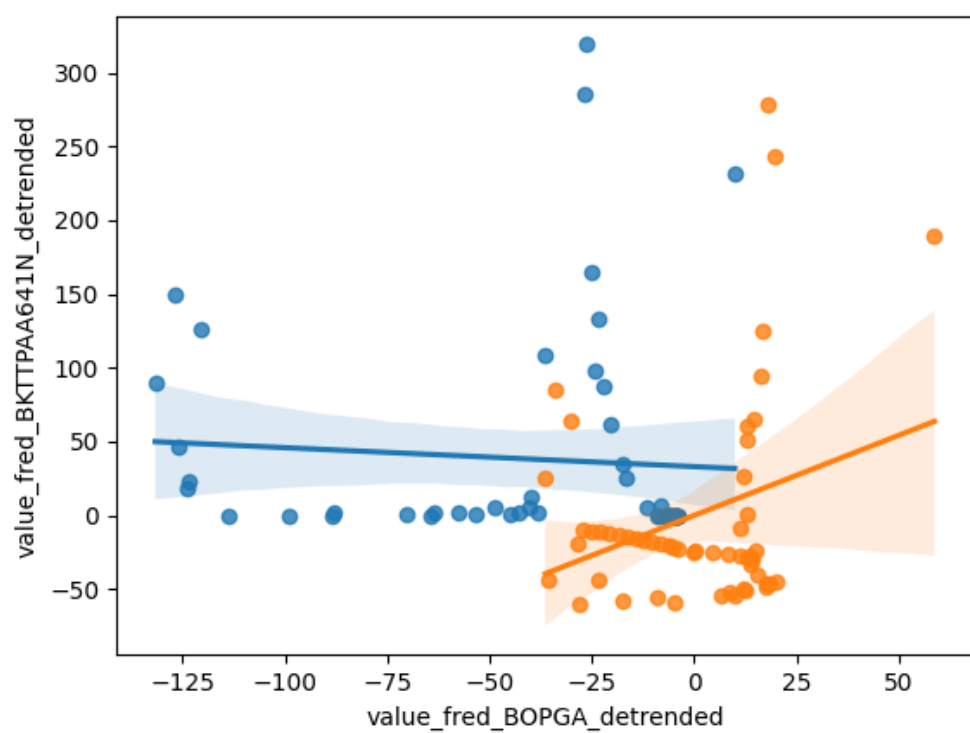


Figure 8: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-07-24

6 Date: 2026-07-25

Series ID: Y055RC1A027NBEA

This series is titled Government Gross Investment: Intellectual Property Products and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Billions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1929-01-01 and the observation end date is 2025-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: CIS1013000000000I

This series is titled Employment Cost Index: Total compensation for All Civilian workers in Manufacturing and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index Dec 2005=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2003-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01. The popularity of this series is 2.

6.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CIS1013000000000I	R-squared:	0.958			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.956			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	484.1			
Date:	Sat, 25 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	5.52e-16			
Time:	12:55:27	Log-Likelihood:	-65.151			
No. Observations:	23	AIC:	134.3			
Df Residuals:	21	BIC:	136.6			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	57.3163	3.046	18.816	0.000	50.981	63.651
value_fred_Y055RC1A027NBEA	0.2886	0.013	22.003	0.000	0.261	0.316
	Omnibus:	4.531	Durbin-Watson:	0.215		
	Prob(Omnibus):	0.104	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.139		
	Skew:	0.450	Prob(JB):	0.343		
	Kurtosis:	1.808	Cond. No.	788.		

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.



6.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CIS1013000000000I_detrended	R-squared:	0.842
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.835
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	112.3
Date:	Sat, 25 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	6.97e-10
Time:	12:55:27	Log-Likelihood:	-40.429
No. Observations:	23	AIC:	84.86
Df Residuals:	21	BIC:	87.13
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	5.629e-12	0.306	1.84e-11	1.000	-0.637	0.637
value_fred_Y055RC1A027NBEA_detrended	0.1364	0.013	10.595	0.000	0.110	0.163

Omnibus:	3.828	Durbin-Watson:	0.613
Prob(Omnibus):	0.147	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.028
Skew:	-0.611	Prob(JB):	0.363
Kurtosis:	3.790	Cond. No.	23.8

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

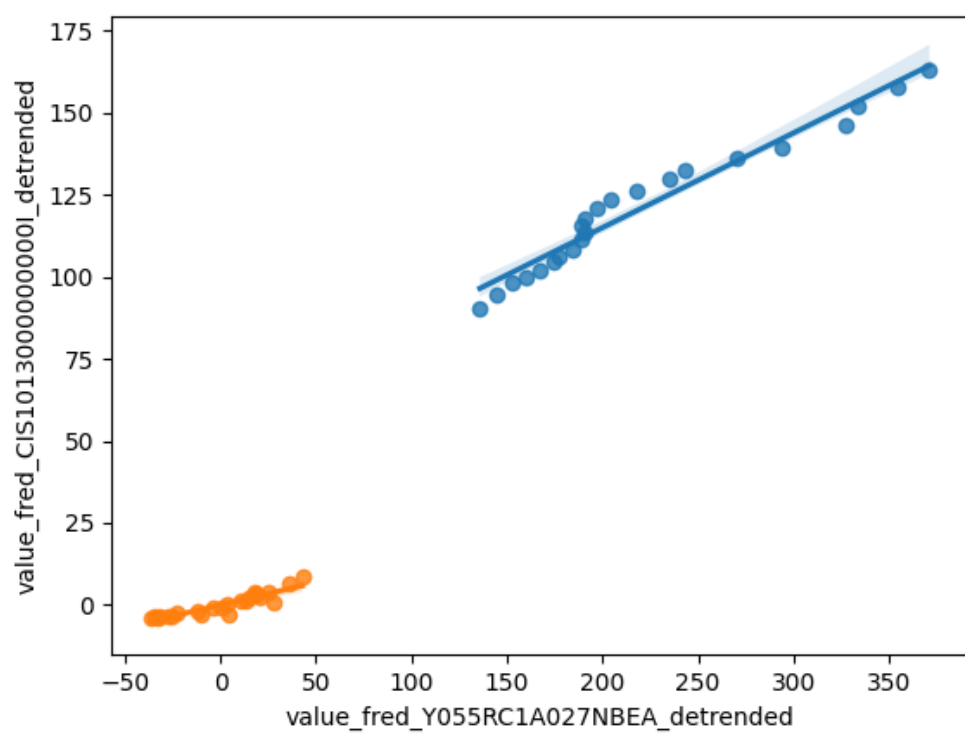


Figure 10: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-07-25